Acanthus mollis

Bear’s breeches, Bear’s breech, Oyster plant

Also known as: Common bear’s breech, Soft-leaved bear’s breech | Family: Acanthaceae

Passage N_S: 43 **TOTAL 43**



HABIT



OTHER



OTHER



FLOWER

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Not stated

Evergreen or deciduous
Evergreen

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: 3–5 ft tall × 2–3 ft wide (foliage mound); flower spikes to 5–6 ft. Clump-forming; can spread by rootstocks.
net; NC State Extension; The Spru

Sun

Water

Soil
Average, fertile, well-drained soils; tolerates range except poorly drained. net; NC State; BBC Gardeners’ World

Zone 8a
Hardy USDA zones 7–10. Evergreen or semi-evergreen in warm wir climates. Suitable for Atlanta Zone 8a with good drainage and some afternoon shade in hot summers.
May go summer-dormant without irrigation. net

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Native to southern Europe and northwestern Africa (Mediterranean region). Not native to North America

Form
Herbaceous perennial. Bold basal mound of deeply lobed, glossy dark green leaves (to 2 ft long). Tall spikes of creamy white (sometimes pink) hooded flowers with spiny reddish-purple bracts, late spring to midsummer. No notable bark (herbaceous). Leaves mostly evergreen in mild winters. net; NC State. Architectural plant; leaves inspired Corinthian motif. Attracts bees. Suitable for borders, cottage gardens, Mediterranean gardens. net

Foliage
Not stated

Flowers and fruit
Not stated

Bark
Not stated

PLANTING NOTES

Establishment

Medium maintenance. Remove flowering stalks after bloom.
Propagate by division or root cuttings.
Provide good drainage. net

HEALTH

Health

Virtually pest-free. Watch for powdery mildew. Can be difficult to eradicate once established due to rootstocks. Not invasive in most of the Southeast per available notes.
net; Missouri Botanical Garden

Symptoms

None stated